

Nikolina Klatt

Freie Universität Berlin
Cluster of Excellence
“Contestations of the Liberal Script – SCRIPTS”
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CURRENT POSITIONS

10.2024 – present **Doctoral Researcher**, SCRIPTS, Cluster of Excellence at Freie Universität Berlin
01.2025 – present **Visiting Research Fellow**, WZB Berlin, *Transformations of Democracy*
06.2025 – present **Freelance Data Analyst**

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Comparative Politics
- Democratization and Autocratization
- Reproductive Rights
- Computational Social Science and Text as Data

EDUCATION

2024 – 2027 **Ph.D. in Political Science** at the Otto-Suhr-Institute Freie Universität Berlin
Dissertation: *Reproductive Rights and Political Regime Transformations*
Berlin Graduate School for Global and Transregional Studies (BGTS) of
SCRIPTS, Cluster of Excellence
2021 – 2024 **Master of Public Policy**, Hertie School, Berlin
Thesis: *The Effect of Judicial Decisions on Policy Narratives. Analyzing the
Impact of Roe v. Wade's Overturning on Digital Discourse Using Machine
Learning* (grade 1.0)
2022 **Bachelor of Arts in Political Science**, FernUniversität in Hagen, Germany
Thesis: *“Scientific evidence in policy narratives”* (grade 1.0)
Commencement Speaker
2011 **Master of Arts in Art History**, University of Vienna, Austria
2007 – 2008 Visiting Student, University of Edinburgh, Scotland, UK

PREVIOUS POSITIONS

02/2024 – 12/2024 **Research Fellow**, WZB Berlin, “Transformations of Democracy” unit
Speaker of the Doctoral Researchers at WZB
02/2024 – 05/2024 **Research Fellow**, Bundestag for Anna Lührmann, Minister of State for
Europe and Climate
10/2021 – 12/2023 **Student Research Assistant**, WZB Berlin
03/2020 – 07/2020 **Research Assistant**, CoronaNet Research Project
2017 – 2018 **Program Development Assistant**, Friendship Ambassadors Foundation,
NYC
2015 – 2017 **Gallery Assistant**, Galerie Valentien, Stuttgart, Germany
2012 – 2014 **Trainee and Book Editor**, frechverlag GmbH, Stuttgart, Germany

AWARDS

2024 **Data Science Thesis Award 2024**
by the Data Science Lab at the Hertie School
2024 **Best Poster Award at the #4GenderStudies Poster Exhibition**
by the Margherita-von-Brentano Center for Gender Studies

SCHOLARSHIPS & GRANTS

2024 **Travel Grant**, American Political Science Association (APSA)
2021 – 2023 **Hans N. Weiler Fellowship**, Hertie School of Governance
2019 – 2021 **Deutschlandstipendium Scholarship**, FernUniversität Hagen
2010 **Research Scholarship**, Royal Academy of Arts and the Paul Mellon Center
for British Art, London, UK

PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Klatt, Nikolina and Blum, Sonja. 2024 "How does the use of evidence in policy narratives change during crises? A comparative study of New York City's pandemic school shutdowns." In: *Review of Policy Research* (Early View), [10.1111/ropr.12589](https://doi.org/10.1111/ropr.12589)

Klatt, Nikolina and Böhret, Ines. 2021. "Women's Rights in Childbirth during the COVID-19 Pandemic: A comparison of WHO guidelines to policies, recommendations, and practices in the US and Germany." In: *Cross-cultural Human Rights Review* (3):1–41, [10.52854/cchrr-51](https://doi.org/10.52854/cchrr-51)

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Vanessa Boese-Schlosser, **Nikolina Klatt**, Daniel Meißner, Janice Ngiam, Daniel Ziblatt. 2025. *How Survey Design Influences People's Understanding of Democracy*. WZB Discussion Paper SP V 2025-504. Berlin: WZB.

Klatt, Nikolina. 2024. "[Judicial Rulings and Political Narratives. Analyzing the Impact of Roe v. Wade's Overturning on Digital Discourse Using Machine Learning](#)". WZB Discussion Paper SP V 2024-502. Berlin: WZB.

Klatt, Nikolina. 2024. "[Zwischen Fortschritt und Rückschritt. Der komplexe Kampf um Frauenrechte weltweit](#)" In: *WZB-Mitteilungen* H. 1(183): 33–36.

Vanessa Boese-Schlosser, Fabio Ellger, **Nikolina Klatt**, Janice Ngiam und Daniel Ziblatt. 2024. "[Als Begriff umstritten, als Modell umkämpft. Was Menschen in Deutschland unter „Demokratie“ verstehen](#)" In: *WZB-Mitteilungen* H. 1(183):20–24.

Klatt, Nikolina and Boese-Schlosser, Vanessa. 2023. "[Zwischen Fakten und Fiktion. Wie industrielle Desinformation die Demokratie bedroht](#)" In: *WZB-Mitteilungen*, H. 2(180):32–35.

Klatt, Nikolina and Boese-Schlosser, Vanessa. 2023. "[Authoritarianism and Disinformation: The Dangerous Link](#)." In *The Loop. ECPR's Political Science Blog*

Klatt, Nikolina; Hellmeier, Sebastian and Ziblatt, Daniel. 2022. "[Politische Gewalt und Demokratie](#)." In: *WZB-Mitteilungen*, H. 4(178):62.

Klatt, Nikolina. 2022. "Die Schließungen des öffentlichen Schulsystems in New York City während der Covid-19-Pandemie – Eine Fallstudie zu politischen Erzählungen." In: *Facetten Politischer Kommunikation – Beiträge zum 18. Düsseldorfer Forum Politische Kommunikation*, edited by Lara Boden, Robin Schröer, Natalie Ryba, and Leon Becher, Shaker Verlag GmbH. <https://doi.org/10.2370/9783844087567>

WORK IN PROGRESS

- *Judicial Decisions and Political Narratives. The Effect of Roe v. Wade's Overturning on Digital Discourse. **Revise & Resubmit***
- *Women's Place is in the Statehouse: The Politics of Presence in Discourse before and after Dobbs* with Danielle Pullan and Payton Gannon
- "Authoritarianism and disinformation," with Vanessa Boese-Schlosser, *Encyclopedia of Authoritarianism* edited by Thomas Ambrosio and Stephen Hall
- "Democratization, de-democratization, and human rights," *Handbook of Democratization and De-Democratization* edited by Matthijs Bogaards

CONFERENCES and WORKSHOPS

- 2025 **MPSA**, Annual Conference, Presenter
Politics and Gender Conference (**PAGC**), Presenter
1st Annual Interdisciplinary WZB Conference, Presenter
- 2024 **ECPG, Section Chair** "Reproductive Justice: Policy, Politics, and Intersectionality"
 - Organization of 9 panels
 - Roles: Panel Chair, Co-Chair, Discussant and Presenter**APSA** Annual Meeting 2024, Presenter
Conference on Policy Process Research (**COPPR**), Presenter
Research Day on Intersectional Gender Politics, **Freie Universität Berlin**
- 2023 **ECPR** General Conference, Presenter
APSA Annual Meeting 2023, Presenter
6th International Conference on Public Policy (**ICPP6**), Presenter
ECPR Joint Sessions Workshop, Presenter and Discussant
- 2022 **ECPR** General Conference, Presenter
European Conference on Politics and Gender (**ECPG**), Presenter
International Workshop for Public Policy (**IWPP**), Presenter
- 2021 **DVPW**-Conference, Presenter

TEACHING

04.2025 – 07.2025

Co-leader of a Student Research Group on “*Backlash Against Gender: Comparative Perspectives on Europe’s Anti-Gender Politics*” funded by the Berlin University Alliance

WORKSHOPS AND TRAINING

03/2025 **Comparing Countries with Multivariate Statistical Techniques**, ECPR Methods School by Bruno Cautrès

02/2025 **Automated Image and Video Data Analysis with Python**, DiMES Workshop by Felicia Loecherbach

07/2023 **Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS)** at WZB. Focus on text as data, website scraping, machine learning, and ethics

04/2023 **Developing Bots & Scrapers with Python** by Pierre Daix-Moreux, Hertie School

03/2023 **Introduction to Python** by Joshua Ayodele Aje, Hertie School

11/2022 **Tools for Data Science Workshop**
Presentation of “janitor” package: [Video](#) and [Materials](#)

09/2022 **Introduction to Recommender Systems** by Pierre Daix-Moreux, Hertie School

05/2022 **Data Management for Social Scientists** by Nils Weidmann at WZB Berlin

08/2021 **The Science of Stories: Theory and Practice of the Narrative Policy Framework** by Elizabeth A. Shanahan

ACADEMIC SERVICE

10/2024 – present Speaker of the Doctoral Researchers at SCRIPTS, Freie Universität Berlin

03/2024 – 05/2025 Speaker of the Doctoral Researchers at WZB

2024 Selection Committee Member for Seed Money call at the WZB

2024 Selection Committee Member for the WZB Merit Fellowship

Organizer

ECPG 2024, Section Chair “Reproductive Justice: Policy, Politics, and Intersectionality”

- Organization of 9 panels
- Roles: Panel Chair, Co-Chair, Discussant and Presenter

Reviewer

Discussion Paper Series of the Max Planck Institute for the Study of Societies
Interdisciplinary Political Studies (IdPS)

SKILLS

Technical Skills

R & Python

Experimental Analysis and Causal Inference
Web Scraping and Automated Data Collection
Quantitative Text Analysis and Natural Language Processing
Machine Learning
LaTeX, HTML, Markdown

Languages

German (native)
English (bilingual proficiency, TOEFL 115/120)
French, Spanish, Croatian, Macedonian, ASL (elementary)

October 7, 2025